

Agile Meetings

Agile follows a series of structured meetings (also called Scrum Events or Ceremonies) that help the team plan, monitor progress, identify issues, and continuously improve. Each meeting has a specific purpose and is conducted at different stages of the sprint.

1. Sprint Planning Meeting

The Sprint Planning Meeting is the first meeting conducted at the beginning of every sprint. Its main purpose is to decide what work will be completed during the sprint and how the team will accomplish it. This meeting provides a clear roadmap for the entire sprint by selecting the highest-priority work from the Product Backlog and creating a realistic plan. It ensures that every team member understands the sprint objectives before development begins.

Objectives

- To define a clear Sprint Goal that the team will achieve by the end of the sprint.
- To select the highest-priority Product Backlog Items (PBIs) for development.
- To estimate the effort required to complete each user story or task.
- To divide large user stories into smaller and manageable development tasks.
- To create a Sprint Backlog that contains all the planned work for the sprint.
- To ensure the team has a common understanding of the requirements and expected outcomes.

Participants

Three major roles participate in the Sprint Planning Meeting.

Product Owner

The Product Owner explains the business requirements, presents the highest-priority Product Backlog Items, clarifies user stories, and answers any questions raised by the development team. The Product Owner also ensures that the selected work provides maximum business value.

Scrum Master

The Scrum Master facilitates the meeting, ensures Scrum principles are followed, manages the meeting time, and helps resolve any issues that arise during planning. The Scrum Master also makes sure that everyone actively participates in the discussion.

Development Team

The Development Team estimates the effort required for each task, discusses technical implementation approaches, breaks user stories into smaller tasks, and decides how much work can realistically be completed during the sprint.

Activities Performed

- ❖ The Product Backlog is reviewed and prioritized.
- ❖ The Sprint Goal is discussed and finalized.
- ❖ User stories are selected for the sprint.
- ❖ Story points or effort estimates are assigned.
- ❖ Development tasks are created from user stories.
- ❖ Team capacity is evaluated before finalizing the workload.
- ❖ The Sprint Backlog is prepared and approved.

Duration

The Sprint Planning Meeting is conducted only once at the beginning of every sprint. For a two-week sprint, the meeting usually lasts between two and four hours. For a four-week sprint, it may take up to eight hours depending on the complexity of the project.

Benefits

- ❖ It provides a clear direction before development starts.
- ❖ It helps the team understand customer requirements thoroughly.
- ❖ It improves task estimation and planning accuracy.
- ❖ It prevents confusion and unnecessary changes during the sprint.
- ❖ It ensures that every team member understands their responsibilities.

- ❖ It increases the chances of successfully achieving the Sprint Goal.

2. Daily Standup Meeting (Daily Scrum)

The Daily Standup Meeting, also known as the Daily Scrum, is a short meeting held every working day during the sprint. It helps the development team review progress, discuss current work, identify blockers, and coordinate daily activities. The meeting keeps everyone informed about the project's progress and ensures that work continues smoothly without delays.

Objectives

- To review the work completed since the previous day.
- To discuss the tasks planned for the current day.
- To identify blockers or challenges affecting progress.
- To improve communication among team members.
- To ensure that everyone is working toward the Sprint Goal.
- To detect problems early so they can be resolved quickly.

Participants

The Daily Standup Meeting mainly involves the Development Team, while other Scrum members may also attend.

Development Team

Each team member explains the work completed, describes the work planned for the day, and reports any obstacles preventing progress.

Scrum Master

The Scrum Master facilitates the meeting, ensures that it stays focused and within the time limit, and works to remove any blockers identified by the team after the meeting.

Product Owner (Optional)

The Product Owner may attend to understand the team's progress and answer questions if needed, but usually does not actively lead the discussion.

Activities Performed

During the Daily Standup Meeting, every team member answers three important questions.

- ❖ What work was completed yesterday?
- ❖ What work will be completed today?
- ❖ Are there any blockers or issues preventing progress?

The team also discusses dependencies, updates project status, and coordinates work among members to ensure smooth development.

Duration

The Daily Standup Meeting is conducted every working day during the sprint. It is intentionally limited to 15 minutes so that discussions remain focused and efficient.

Benefits

- ❖ It improves communication among team members.
- ❖ It increases transparency regarding project progress.
- ❖ It identifies risks and blockers at an early stage.
- ❖ It promotes accountability and responsibility.
- ❖ It improves coordination between team members.
- ❖ It helps the team remain focused on achieving the Sprint Goal.

3. Sprint Retrospective Meeting

The Sprint Retrospective Meeting is conducted after the sprint has been completed. Unlike other meetings that focus on the product, this meeting focuses on the team's working process. The objective is to evaluate what went well, identify challenges encountered during the sprint, and determine improvements that can be implemented in future sprints. It is one of the most important meetings for continuous improvement in Agile.

Objectives

- To evaluate how the sprint was executed.

- To identify successful practices followed during the sprint.
- To discuss problems and challenges faced by the team.
- To determine the root causes of recurring issues.
- To create improvement actions for the next sprint.
- To enhance teamwork and overall productivity.

Participants

All Scrum Team members participate in the Sprint Retrospective.

Scrum Master

The Scrum Master facilitates the meeting, encourages honest communication, ensures everyone participates equally, and guides the team toward identifying meaningful improvements.

Product Owner

The Product Owner shares feedback regarding collaboration, communication, and business outcomes while participating in discussions on process improvements.

Development Team

The Development Team discusses technical challenges, shares lessons learned, identifies process improvements, and suggests practical solutions to improve future sprint performance.

Activities Performed

- ❖ The team reviews what went well during the sprint.
- ❖ The team identifies problems and challenges encountered.
- ❖ The root causes of issues are analyzed.
- ❖ Suggestions for improving processes and collaboration are discussed.
- ❖ Action items are created for implementation in the next sprint.
- ❖ Responsibilities for improvement activities are assigned.

Duration

The Sprint Retrospective is conducted once at the end of every sprint after the

Sprint Review Meeting. Depending on the sprint length, it generally lasts between one and three hours.

Benefits

- ❖ It encourages continuous learning and improvement.
- ❖ It helps eliminate recurring problems.
- ❖ It improves communication and collaboration.
- ❖ It increases team productivity and efficiency.
- ❖ It strengthens trust among team members.
- ❖ It improves the quality of future sprint deliveries.
- ❖ It helps build a culture of continuous process improvement.

Aspect	Sprint Planning Meeting	Daily Standup Meeting	Sprint Retrospective Meeting
Purpose	Plan sprint work	Track daily progress	Improve team process
Frequency	Once per sprint	Daily	Once per sprint
Duration	2–8 hours	15 minutes	1–3 hours
Participants	Product Owner, Scrum Master, Development Team.	Development Team, Scrum Master (Product Owner optional).	Product Owner, Scrum Master, Development Team.
Main Focus	Sprint planning	Progress & blockers	Team improvement
Output	Sprint Goal & Backlog	Daily updates	Action plan